35. Soils of Western Rajasthan have a high content of:

(a) Aluminum (b) Calcium
(c) Nitrogen (d) Phosphorus

Ans. (b) : Soil of Western Rajasthan have a high content of Calcium. These soils have rich content of iron- oxide and devoid of calcium salts because calcium salts are soluble in water and are easily washed away.

36. The Neyveli thermal power plant is fed by

(a) Gondwana coal (b) Tertiary coal
(c) Quarternary coal (d) Cambrian coal

Ans. (b) : Liginite Coal is mainly found in Neyveli Lignite fields of Cuddalore district and it is used in Neyveli thermal power plant. Liginite coal are termed as tertiary Coal .Around 90% of total lignite reserve is found in Tamil Nadu.

37. At the present state of our knowledge and resources position, India will remain self sufficient for the next three decades in:

(a) Tin (b) Coking Coal
(c) Copper (d) Petroleum

Ans. (b) : While India, with meagre reserves and production of coking coal, does not figure in the world rankings. India's Coking Coal reserves have been stagnant over the years. The vulnerability of the steel sector springs from the low availability and poor quality of the material in the domestic market. India's total coal reserves have shown an increase of about 7 billion tonnes during 2014-16, but there has hardly been any addition to coking coal reserves and there is no increase in the prime coking coal category. The prime coking coal reserves stand at 5.313 billion tonnes and proved prime coking coal reserves are 4.614 billions. Jharia Coal fields in Jharkhand, which hold the major share of quality coking coal reserves continue to witness raging fires despite the best efforts being put in over the decade.

38. Which one of the following shows the descending order of the four metropolitan cities in the Indian subcontinent in so far as their population strength is concerned?

(a) Bombay, Calcutta, Dhaka, New Delhi
(b) Bombay, Calcutta, New Delhi, Karachi
(c) Bombay, Calcutta, Karachi, New Delhi
(d) Calcutta, Bombay, Dhaka, Karachi

Ans. (b) : At the time when question was asked , the correct order of population strength in descending order are :

Bombay > Calcutta > New Delhi > Karachi.

But at present (Census 2011) the population strength in correct order are:

Bombay > New Delhi > Calcutta >Karachi.

39. Which one of the following is the best strategy for environment friendly sustainable development in Indian agriculture?

(a) Expansion of cultivable land, increased use of superphosphate, urea and effective biocides.
(b) Wider popularization of high yielding crop varieties, better and more frequent irrigation and increased frequency of aerial sprays of inorganic fertilizers and pesticides.
(c) Mixed cropping, organic manures, nitrogen fixing plants and pest resistant crop varieties.
(d) Improved farm implements and machinery, use of potent insecticides to minimize post harvest grain losses and mono culture cropping practices.

Ans. (c) : Mixed cropping, organic manures, nitrogen fixing plants and pest resistant crop varieties are the best strategy for environment friendly sustainable development in Indian agriculture.

40. The earnings of India from diamond export is quite high. Which one of the following factors has contributed to it?

(a) Pre independence stockpiling of diamonds in the country which are now exported.
(b) Large production of industrial diamonds in the country.
(c) Expertise available for cutting and polishing of imported diamonds which are then exported.
(d) As in the past, India produces huge quantity of gem diamonds which are exported.

Ans. (c) : The earnings of India from diamond export is quite high because of expertise available for cutting and polishing of imported diamonds which are then exported.

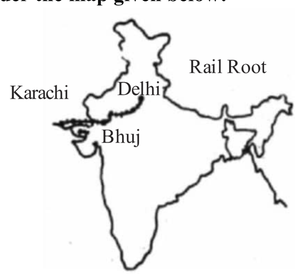
41. Which one of the following provides the correct sequence of occurrence of four towns/cities as one proceeds from west to east?

(a) Rajkot, Baroda, Kharagpur, Bilaspur
(b) Bikaner, Aligarh, Darbhanga, Nowgong
(c) Indore, Rourkela, Agartala, Jamshedpur
(d) Nasik, Aurangabad, Berhampur, Nanded

Ans. (b) : The correct sequence of occurrence of four towns/cities as one proceeds from west to east are :

Bikaner (Rajasthan) ⟶ Aligarh (Uttar Pradesh) ⟶ Darbhanga (Bihar) ⟶ Nowgong (Assam)

42. Consider the map given below:



Two tourists, one travelling from Delhi to Karachi and the other to Bhuj, wanted company. The railway Junction up to which they can travel together as shown in the:

(a) Phulera
(b) Jodhpur
(c) Luni
(d) Balotra

Ans. (d) : As per the location mentioned in the map it is cleared that the location is Balotra.

43. Which one of the following is the best strategy for environment friendly sustainable development in Indian agriculture?

(a) Expansion of cultivable land, increased use of superphosphate, urea and effective biocides.
(b) Wider popularization of high yielding crop varieties, better and more frequent irrigation and increased frequency of aerial sprays of inorganic fertilizers and pesticides.
(c) Mixed cropping, organic manures, nitrogen fixing plants and pest resistant crop varieties.
(d) Improved farm implements and machinery, use of potent insecticides to minimise postharvest grain losses and mono culture cropping practices.

Ans. (c) : For sustainable development in Indian Agriculture-

- Mixed cropping (Crop Rotation)
- Organic Manures (Organic farming)
- N. Fixing Plant (Source -CEEW. Gov.)

India has huge reserve of natural gas. Natural gas reserves have been found in Bombay High, Gujarat, Assam, Tamil Nadu and Tripura. Despite the availability of natural gas in abundance, it is not being fully utilized. Natural gas is used in the production of chemical fertilizers especially urea. IFFCO fertilizer at Amla (Bareilly) and Kondala (Gujarat) are based on natural gas.

44. Next to Hindi, the language spoken by the largest number of people in the Indian subcontinent is:

(a) Urdu (b) Telugu
(c) Bengali (d) Tamil

Ans. (b) : Bengali is the most spoken language in the Indian subcontinent after India. The Bengali language is spoken by about 215 million people in the Indian State of West Bengal and Bangladesh.

After Hindi and Bengali, Urdu and Punjabi are the most spoken language.

In India Telugu is 2nd most spoken language after Hindi.

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

45. Even though Pluto is usually the farthest planet, its path is highly elliptical, crossing inside the path of some other planet. As a result for a period of twenty years from 1979, the farthest planet is not Pluto but:

(a) Jupiter (b) Saturn
(c) Uranus (d) Neptune

Ans. (d) : Neptune is the eighth and farthest-known Solar planet from the Sun. In the Solar System, it is the fourth-largest planet by diameter, the third-most-massive planet, and the densest giant planet. It is 17 times the mass of Earth, slightly more massive than its near-twin Uranus. Neptune is denser and physically smaller than Uranus because its greater mass causes more gravitational compression of its atmosphere.

46. When there is depletion of ozone in the stratosphere, the wavelength of radiation striking the earth's surface will be:

(a) 10^-7 M (b) 10^-10 M
(c) 10^-2 M (d) 100 M

Ans. (a) : UV light has a shorter wavelength than visible light. Ultraviolet radiation lies between visible light and X-rays along the electromagnetic spectrum. UV "light" spans a range of wavelengths between about 10 and 400 nanometers.

1nm =10^ - 9

400 nm = 4 *10 ^ - 7 M

47. The solar eclipse achieves totality only in the limited geographical regions because:

(a) The earth is not a smooth flat surface, but has elevations and depressions
(b) The size of the shadow of the moon on the earth is small compared to the cross section of the earth
(c) The trajectories of the earth around the sun and the moon around the earth are not perfect circles
(d) Sun rays can reach most of the peripheral regions of the shadow of the moon due to a atmospheric refraction

Ans. (b) : The solar eclipse achieves totality only in the limited geographical regions because the size of the shadow of the moon on the earth is small compared to the cross section of the earth.

48. Which one of the following is NOT an astronomical object?

(a) Pulsar (b) Brittle Star
(c) Black hole (d) Quasar

Ans. (b) : Brittle star, also called serpent star, any of the 2,100 living species of marine invertebrates constituting the subclass Ophiuro idea (phylum Echinodermata). Their long, thin arms usually five and often forked and spiny are distinctly set off from the small disk-shaped body.